

STATghost

Quick manual — copy → local engines → text/plot

v0.4.5 · 2026

A sniper, not a Swiss army knife. No editor; clipboard + R / Python / Julia.

1 30-second start

1. Unzip so `statghost.exe` and `statghost_rhost.exe` stay together (rhost is only needed for R.dll).
2. Run `statghost.exe` (toolbar, top-right).
3. Under **Set** → **Session**, pick language **R**, **Python**, or **Julia** and (if needed) the engine path.
4. Click **Idle** → **Armed** (amber).
5. In another app, select code and copy (**Ctrl+C**) — or use the optional Capture hotkey with *no* selection (see below).
6. See results in **Console** / **Plot**.

2 Traffic lights

- **Set** — preferences (opacity, session, hotkeys, SynEdit, plot).
- **Idle/Armed** — clipboard sniper on/off.
- **Kill** — stop *this app's* current engine child (see below).
- **Panel** — show/hide the output window.
- **Clear** — clear console and plot.

STATghost icon: menu *Help / About / OS global hotkeys / Quit* (click the icon). Drag the bar by the background or the name. Status shows engine badge and HK: `on|off`.

3 Engines (R / Python / Julia)

Under **Set** → **Session** (Path | Options):

- **Use** — **R** | **Python** | **Julia**.
- **R**: home (empty = newest on this PC); Use `{Rterm.exe | R.dll}`. R.dll talks via sidecar `statghost_rhost.exe` (GUI never loads R.dll).
- **Python**: interpreter path (empty = discover); Options — show Matplotlib window; prefetch imports on session start.
- **Julia**: path (empty = discover / juliaup); Options — show GR window when relevant. Plot panel PNGs use the same high-res size class as R/Python (`Plots.jl savefig of current()`).
- **R Options**: show `rgl` window when relevant.

Status badge examples: `R.dll · 4.5.0`, `Python · 3.12`, `Julia · 1.11`, or `idle`.

4 Kill

- Ends only STATghost's current child — `Rterm.exe`, `statghost_rhost.exe`, Python, or Julia — not RStudio / other IDEs.
- Works mid-eval (hard terminate). Toolbar returns to green Idle; click **Arm** for a fresh session.
- Changing language / paths / R Use while running kills the old session first.

5 Clipboard and dedup

When **Armed**, eval runs only if clipboard *text* changes. Copying the same selection again does **not** re-run (feature, not a bug). To repeat: change one character, or use a dedicated Capture hotkey (if set).

Current line without selection

Under **Set** → **Hotkey** → **Capture**, record an **alternative** global chord (optional). That hotkey asks the foreground app to **Copy**, then STATghost evaluates the clipboard. In many editors (VS Code, Notepad++, RStudio, CudaText, ...), Copy with **no selection** copies the **current line** — so you can step a script line by line without selecting. Behaviour depends on the source app; if Copy does nothing without a selection, select text as usual (or use **Ctrl+C** when Armed).

Operational notices go to the console meta stream; the status bar shows the engine badge and short tips. Console always scrolls to the latest line, even when the Plot tab is active.

6 Panel

- **Console** — read-only SynEdit; `Ctrl+Tab` / `Shift+Ctrl+Tab` switch Console ↔ Plot. The active tab highlight follows the page after eval focus (Auto / Console / Plot). Echo prompts: R `>+|`, Python `>>>/. . .`, Julia `julia>/julia|` (continuation is classroom-style).
- After eval, focus is **Auto** by default: **Plot** if this eval drew graphics, else **Console** (Set → Plot panel to force Console or Plot).
- **Plot** — high-res PNG (R, Python Matplotlib, Julia Plots.jl); zoom, history ←/→, optional PDF (R).
- **Size** (Plot panel) — match plot to pane width (default on).
- Bookmarks (if enabled): `Ctrl+Shift+0..9` / `Ctrl+0..9`.

7 Settings

- **Appearance** — opacity, toolbar orientation, theme.
- **Session** — Path | Options per language (see Engines); `Ctrl+Tab` / `Shift+Ctrl+Tab` cycle R|Python|Julia pages (does not change Active Use radios).
- **Hotkey** — Capture / Arm / Focus / Clear console: **Record** and Clear|Reset. Capture default stays **Ctrl+C** when Armed; optional alternative chord (Copy in the source app → eval; often the current line with no selection — see Clipboard). **Ctrl+L** clears Console text only (plot unchanged); toolbar Clear still wipes console + plot. `Alt+Space` is rejected (Windows system menu).
- **Editor** — font, highlighter, view options; `Ctrl+Tab` / `Shift+Ctrl+Tab` cycle Font|Syntax.
- **Plot panel** — history, PDF, after-eval focus, Size.

8 Hotkeys

- **Ctrl+Alt+R** — Arm / Idle (default; Record under Set).
- **Ctrl+C** — Capture via system clipboard (when Armed).
- Optional Capture alternative (Record under Set) — Copy in the foreground app, then eval (current line without selection in many editors).
- **Ctrl+Alt+F** — Focus mode toggle (default).
- **Ctrl+L** — Clear Console text only (default; R console).
- Brand menu **OS global hotkeys** — when off, Arm / alt-capture / focus / clear chords are unregistered so other apps can use them; status shows HK: off. Ctrl+C sniper while Armed still works.

9 Config

Prefs JSON: `%LOCALAPPDATA%\STATghost/statghost.json`.

10 Automated checks (lab)

- **Smoke:** `statghost.exe --smoke → statg5_report.txt (RESULT=BOK)`.
- **SR / SP / SJ / ST:** whole-file samples — `--sr (R rterm+rdll), --sp (Python), --sj (Julia), --st / --tf-samples (all) → statg_sr|sp|sj|st_report.txt`. Or: `powershell -File src/tf_samples.ps1 [-Mode ST|SR|SP|SJ]`.

11 Troubleshooting

- No output — **Armed?** New clipboard text? Correct language under Session? Badge not idle?
- No plot — this chunk must draw (`plot`, `Matplotlib`, `Plots.jl`, ...).
- R.dll won't start — is `statghost_rhost.exe` next to the app? Is `R.dll` under R home? Or switch Use to `Rterm.exe`.
- Python / Julia not found — set path under Session → Path, or install and leave empty for discover.
- Stuck eval — press **Kill**, then Arm again.
- Hotkeys clash with another app — turn off **OS global hotkeys** (sniper Ctrl+C when Armed remains).